Money Moves Workbook

Budget + Inflation Worksheet · MoneyWiseMastery

Educational only. Not financial advice. Figures are illustrations from your own inputs; no returns or savings are guaranteed.

How to use this

1. Open the spreadsheet (Excel, LibreOffice, or upload to Google Drive and open with Google Sheets). Yellow cells are inputs; green cells calculate.
2. Use the Car True Cost tab before you sign: enter the real price, APR, term, and running costs from your quotes.
3. Once a month, fill in the Price Check page with prices from your own receipts and statements.
4. Fill in the budget plan at the start of the month and the actuals at the end.

Rate vs level, in one line

A lower inflation *rate* means prices are rising more slowly, not falling. The *price level* is the total rise since a starting point. Example: if a $100 basket rises 3% a year for 3 years, it costs $100 \times 1.03^3 \approx \$109.27$.

Personal Price Check

Prices from your statements. % change = (now – then) ÷ then. Extra per month = (now – then) × times per month.

Item	12 months ago	Now	% change	Times / month	Extra / month
Groceries (weekly trip)					
Eggs (dozen)					
Ground beef (lb)					
Eating out (meal)					
Electricity bill					
Gasoline (gallon)					
Rent / mortgage					
Car insurance					
Phone / internet					
Other					
TOTAL					

Which three items moved most? What is one swap, switch, or quote I can get this month?

Monthly Budget: Plan vs Actual

Month: _____ Take-home income: $_____

Category	Planned	Actual	Difference
Housing			
Utilities			
Groceries			
Transportation (car payment, fuel, insurance)			
Debt payments			
Savings / emergency fund			
Retirement			
Insurance (health, life)			
Phone / internet			
Subscriptions			
Eating out / fun			
Giving			
Other			
TOTAL			

Left over (income – actual total): $_____

Car Decision Checklist

■ Out-the-door price (incl. tax and fees): $_____

■ APR: ____% Term: ____ months Monthly payment: $_____

■ Total of payments (payment × months): $_____

■ Total interest (total of payments – amount financed): $_____

■ Insurance quote for THIS car: $_____/mo

■ Monthly cost to own (payment + insurance + fuel + maintenance): $_____

■ Does the monthly cost to own fit my budget with savings still funded? Yes / No

■ Shorter-term comparison (see Term Compare tab): $_____/mo, saves $_____ interest

Formulas used: Loan payment = P·r ÷ (1 – (1+r)^–n), r = APR/12, n = months. Future value of monthly deposits = PMT·((1+r)^n – 1) ÷ r at a rate YOU choose. Past returns do not predict future returns.

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